Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-12

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 23:1-32

1 So when David was old and full of days, he made his son Solomon king over Israel.

2 And he gathered together all the leaders of Israel, with the priests and the Levites.

3 Now the Levites were numbered from the age of thirty years and above; and the number of individual males was thirty-eight thousand.

4 Of these, twenty-four thousand were to look after the work of the house of the Lord, six thousand were officers and judges,

5 four thousand were gatekeepers, and four thousand praised the Lord with musical instruments, "which I made," said David, "for giving praise."

6 Also David separated them into divisions among the sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.

7 Of the Gershonites: Laadan and Shimei.

8 The sons of Laadan: the first Jehiel, then Zetham and Joel—three in all.

9 The sons of Shimei: Shelomith, Haziel, and Haran—three in all. These were the heads of the fathers' houses of Laadan.

10 And the sons of Shimei: Jahath, Zina, Jeush, and Beriah. These were the four sons of Shimei.

11 Jahath was the first and Zizah the second. But Jeush and Beriah did not have many sons; therefore they were assigned as one father's house.

12 The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel—four in all.

13 The sons of Amram: Aaron and Moses; and Aaron was set apart, he and his sons forever, that he should sanctify the most holy things, to burn incense before the Lord, to minister to Him, and to give the blessing in His name forever.

14 Now the sons of Moses the man of God were reckoned to the tribe of Levi.

15 The sons of Moses were Gershon and Eliezer.

16 Of the sons of Gershon, Shebuel was the first.

17 Of the descendants of Eliezer, Rehabiah was the first. And Eliezer had no other sons, but the sons of Rehabiah were very many.

18 Of the sons of Izhar, Shelomith was the first.

19 Of the sons of Hebron, Jeriah was the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.

20 Of the sons of Uzziel, Michah was the first and Jesshiah the second.

21 The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi. The sons of Mahli were Eleazar and Kish.

22 And Eleazar died, and had no sons, but only daughters; and their brethren, the sons of Kish, took them as wives.

23 The sons of Mushi were Mahli, Eder, and Jeremoth—three in all.

24 These were the sons of Levi by their fathers' houses—the heads of the fathers' houses as they were counted individually by the number of their names, who did the work for the service of the house of the Lord, from the age of twenty years and above.

25 For David said, "The Lord God of Israel has given rest to His people, that they may dwell in Jerusalem forever";

26 and also to the Levites, "They shall no longer carry the tabernacle, or any of the articles for its service."

27 For by the last words of David the Levites were numbered from twenty years old and above;

28 because their duty was to help the sons of Aaron in the service of the house of the Lord, in the courts and in the chambers, in the purifying of all holy things and the work of the service of the house of God,

29 both with the showbread and the fine flour for the grain offering, with the unleavened cakes and what is baked in the pan, with what is mixed and with all kinds of measures and sizes;

30 to stand every morning to thank and praise the Lord, and likewise at evening;

31 and at every presentation of a burnt offering to the Lord on the Sabbaths and on the

New Moons and on the set feasts, by number according to the ordinance governing them, regularly before the Lord;

32 and that they should attend to the needs of the tabernacle of meeting, the needs of the holy place, and the needs of the sons of Aaron their brethren in the work of the house of the Lord.

II. Key Summary

• When David was old, he made Solomon king and gathered the leaders, priests, and Levites; the 38,000 Levites aged thirty and above were divided into four groups: temple workers, officers and judges, gatekeepers, and musicians who praised the Lord (vv. 1–5).

• The chapter lists the family heads of the Levites under Gershon, Kohath, and Merari; Aaron and his sons were set apart to burn incense, minister to God, and bless in His name, while the sons of Moses were counted with the rest of the tribe of Levi (vv. 6–23).

• David said God had given His people rest in Jerusalem, so the Levites no longer had to carry the tabernacle; Levites from twenty years old were now counted, and their duties became helping the priests, purifying holy things, preparing the showbread and grain offerings, keeping the measures, and standing every morning and evening to thank and praise the Lord (vv. 24–32).

III. Passage Analysis

No More Carrying the Tent: Becoming the Priests' "Hands"

> "Serve" literally means "hand" — it means helping the priests do their work, becoming the priests' "hands." ⋯ In this passage David rearranged the Levites' work so that they could truly become "the hands of the priests." Are we willing and able to be "the hands of our church leaders," following their lead and doing a whole lot of service that looks tedious and lowly, yet matters? [1]

Once the tent no longer had to be moved, the Levites went from hauling heavy loads to washing vessels, baking bread, and checking measures beside the priests. Hardly anyone saw this work, but the temple couldn't run without those "hands."

Every Morning and Evening, Standing to Say Thanks

> The Chronicler mentioned many specific duties of the Levites (purifying all holy things…with the showbread…what is baked in the pan). Yet he included among them this most important duty: to stand every morning to thank and praise the LORD. This was essential among the duties of the Levites and the priests, and could never be neglected. [2]

Right in the middle of a long list of washing and baking chores sits "stand morning and evening to give thanks and praise." No matter how busy or ordinary the day gets, thanking God belongs on the daily schedule and shouldn't get squeezed out.

IV. Reflection Question

This week, whose "hands" were you — what's one small thing you did to help them?

In verse 28, the word for "serve" literally means "hand." As the priests' hands, the Levites washed vessels, baked bread, and kept the measures. These chores looked small, yet the passage calls them "the work of the service of the house of God."

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Tsai Che-Min et al., Research Notes on 1 Chronicles, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT23.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, 1 Chronicles 23 – New Duties for the Levites, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-23/